

1.1.3 Analog and Digital Signals

اینالگ سگنل وقت کے ساتھ ہموار انداز میں بدلتا ہے، جیسے سائن ویو (Sine Wave)؛ انسانی آواز اس کی مثال ہے۔

CS XI

Chapter 1: Computer Systems

Lecture 03 of 20

★ Golden

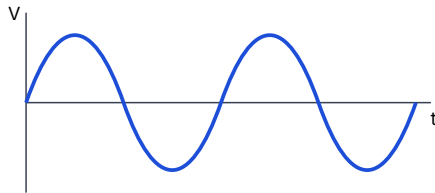
1.1.3 Analog and Digital Signals ★ Golden

LEARN IT

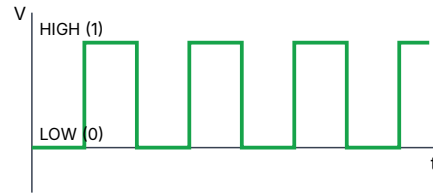
A **signal** is a changing voltage (or other quantity) that carries information.

Analog signals are continuous signals that change smoothly over time, like a **sine wave**. Examples: the human voice, a traditional mercury thermometer.

Digital signals have only two levels: **HIGH (1)** and **LOW (0)**. They jump instantly between these values, which creates a **square wave**. Example: computer data.



Analog Signal (Sine Wave)



Digital Signal (Square Wave)

An analog signal changes smoothly; a digital signal jumps between only two levels.

Feature	Analog data	Digital data
Nature	Continuous flow.	Discrete, separate values (bits).
Wave shape	Sine wave (smooth curve).	Square wave (sudden jumps).
Reliability	Low (affected by noise).	High (resistant to noise).
Examples	Human voice, traditional thermometer.	Computer data.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Why is digital more resistant to noise?

Step 1: Suppose a wire carries 5 V for HIGH and 0 V for LOW.

Step 2: Noise adds a small error, so 5 V arrives as 4.6 V and 0 V arrives as 0.3 V.

Step 3: The receiver only asks "Is it closer to HIGH or LOW?" 4.6 V is still read as 1 and 0.3 V is still read as 0. The data is perfect.

Step 4: In an analog signal, every exact value carries meaning, so 4.6 V instead of 5 V really changes the sound or reading. The noise cannot be removed.

REMEMBER IT

Analog = A smooth curve. Digital = Doorsteps. Analog looks like ocean waves; digital looks like a castle wall (square teeth).

COMMON MISTAKE

Do not draw a digital signal with sloping sides. A digital signal jumps *instantly*, so its edges are straight vertical lines. Also do not confuse "digital" with "electronic": an analog signal can also be electronic.

اردو میں سمجھیں

اینا لاگ سگنل وقت کے ساتھ ہموار انداز میں بدلتا ہے، جیسے سائن ویو (Sine Wave)؛ انسانی آواز اس کی مثال ہے۔ ڈیجیٹل سگنل کی صرف دو سطحیں ہوتی ہیں، HIGH (1) اور LOW (0)، اور یہ اچانک ایک سے دوسری پر جاتا ہے، اس لیے مربع لہر (Square Wave) بنتی ہے۔ ڈیجیٹل سگنل شور سے کم متاثر ہوتا ہے، اس لیے زیادہ قابلِ بھروسہ ہے۔

EXAM TIP

Common questions: "Differentiate between analog and digital signals" (3–4 marks) and "Draw an analog and a digital signal." Write the comparison as a table with at least three features (nature, wave shape, reliability, example). Always label your diagrams: axes V and t, and HIGH(1)/LOW(0) on the square wave.

CHECK YOURSELF

1. What shape of wave does a digital signal make?
2. Which type of signal is more affected by noise?
3. Give one example of an analog signal.

Answers: 1. A square wave. 2. Analog. 3. Human voice (or a traditional thermometer reading).

Next lecture: 1.1.4 Boolean Algebra